

Logitech's G11 gaming keyboard supports multi-color LEDs, automatic game detection for custom profiles, integrated headset support and a USB port

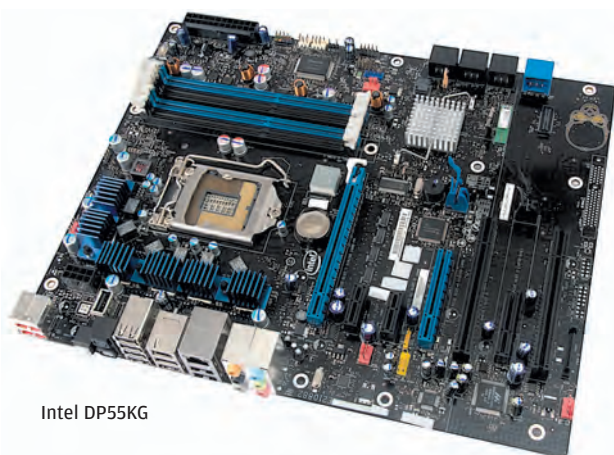


Kingmax introduced cap-less USB drives that are water proof, have pressure resistance and can manage temperatures in the range of 100 to minus 40 degrees

stable operation over typical electrolytic capacitors. A vertical USB port is placed right on the motherboard – ReadyBoost ready?

Conclusion

As you might have already known, there isn't a great difference in the benchmark scores in motherboards mainly because a motherboard is more a facilitator than a performance enhancing component like say, a processor, or memory or a graphics card. Thus, it was important for us to give the features of these boards more weight than the performance. With respect to features, the Gigabyte P55-UD6 aced the list, with the ASUS P7P55D Deluxe just a single point behind it. The third in that list is the MSI P55-GD65. With respect to performance, the prize again was bagged by the Gigabyte P55-UD6, with the MSI brothers right behind at second and third place. But aggressive pricing has been MSI's biggest feat, with both the boards selling at a price of under Rs. 10,000! Out of the two, we feel the MSI P55-GD65 is quite well priced at Rs. 9,200 + taxes. It has quite a list of features, is well built and lets you over-clock at the click of a button on the board itself. Thus,



Intel DP55KG

INTEL BEST PERFORMER COMPARISONS

Brand	ASUS	Gigabyte	ASUS
Model No.	P5Q3 Deluxe WiFi @n	GA-P55-UD6	Rampage II Extreme
Price (Rupees)	Rs. 17,900	Rs. 20,000	Rs.28,500
Chipset	Intel P45	Intel P55	Intel X58
Socket	LGA775	LGA1156	LGA1366
CINEBENCH R10 (CPU)	11847	14975	15490
WinRAR 3.8	2530	4479	4722
DivX Video Encoding (100 MB VOB) (sec)	33.1	21	18
File Transfer - Sequential / Random (8 GB) (Mbps)	50.32 / 42.38	38.64 / 43.81	47.08 / 42.90
STALKER Clear Sky (1280 x 1024, low)	81.2	81.4	84.9
Crysis (CPU - 1024 x 768, low)	84	79	83
Crysis (Graphics - 1280 x 1024, high)	42	44	45

This table compares the best performing motherboards from our tests using the P45, P55 and the X58 chip-set platform respectively. The P45 based board used an Intel Core 2 Extreme QX9650 3.0 GHz processor. The P55 board (winner of the test in this article) used the Core i7 870 at 2.93 GHz which is the fastest for the LGA 1156 socket platform. The X58 based one was paired with a Core i7 975 Extreme Edition clocking at 3.33 GHz; once again the fastest in the LGA 1366 based platform till date. All boards were

tested with the same ASUS GeForce 9800GTX+ Dark Knight graphic card. Identical memory was used, except on the X58 for which tri-channel memory was used. As you can see, certain benchmarks like CineBench and WinRAR show considerable performance gains. The performance gain is clearly visible in the DivX encoding test. To give you a rough estimate of how much it costs to build these rigs; the P45-based CPU-motherboard combo described above would cost roughly around Rs. 65,900. The P55 based setup

would actually cost almost Rs. 20,000 less, at around Rs. 47,000. Intel's fastest and meanest combo (based on the X58 chip-set above) would make your pockets lighter by a whopping Rs. 76,500.

There you have it. This is your money's worth. This is what you'll get for spending those extra thousand rupees to be faster than others. If you compare the numbers of the P55 to the X58, there's not a great difference that's worth the extra Rs. 30,000. Thus, the cost-to-benefit ratio tips in the favour of the P55 based setup.

you can get your Core i5 based CPU-motherboard combo for lower than Rs. 20,000. The Intel DP55KG is just over Rs. 10,000, but does not give you a lot for your money. The Gigabyte P55-UD3R is a decent performer, but the lack of features such as dual-LAN and Firewire ports on-board doesn't quite justify its Rs. 13,800 price tag. If you have deep pockets, and want a really solid board with the highest performance, then the Gigabyte P55-UD6 gives you all that, for Rs. 20,000.

We re-iterate that Intel intends to discontinue LGA 775.

Thus, if you are in the market looking to upgrade or buy a new Intel-based mid-range PC, we'd advise you to go for a P55 based chip-set to ensure compatibility of future processors based on the LGA 1156 socket. Here comes another issue; the decision to either go for a semi-conservative LGA 1156 based board, or go all-in on a high-performing LGA 1366 based one. The table above gives you a comparison of all Intel platforms with the best of CPU-motherboard combinations. We hope you make the right decision. Happy shopping! 

Contact Sheet

Brand	Contact	Phone	Email	Web site
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